Lesson 31

Truth, Seeking

"I have chosen the way of truth;
I have set my heart on your laws."
(Psalm 119:30)

Truth: that which is accurate
with respect to reality

The Bible is the only reliable source of truth for all mankind. It contains the infallible word of God and the story of our Lord and Savior, Jesus Christ. God wants every human being to come to a knowledge of the truth and to be saved. The first, and by far the most important, truth to be grasped is that Jesus Christ, the Son of God, died for our sins so that we might receive eternal life. All other truths in the Bible hinge on this central truth.

As Christians, we are to seek truth and live our lives according to God's word, and after the example of Jesus Christ.

Synopsis

God sent the truth in the form of his son, Jesus Christ.[1] Jesus Himself proclaimed: "I am the way, the truth, and the life."[2] God

We have seen his glory, the glory of the One and Only,
who came from the Father, full of grace and truth.
(John 1:14)[1]

I am the way and the truth and the life.
No one comes to the Father except through me.
(John 14:6)[2]

224 Truth, Seeking

our Savior wants all men to be saved and to come to a knowledge of the truth.[3,4]

If you are a believer, it is important to understand that God chose to give you birth through the word of truth; you are the "first-fruits" of all He created.[5] You were chosen by God from the beginning of time to be saved through the sanctifying work of the Holy Spirit and through belief in the truth.[6]

Throughout the lives of all individuals, God examines us to see if we are walking in the truth.[7] His desire is that His truth penetrates deep within us, to the core of our very being.[8]

In contrast, it is the devil's plan that we believe lies, for he is a liar and the father of lies; there is no truth in him.[9,10] We can protect

God our Savior…who wants all men to be saved
and come to a knowledge of the truth.
(1 Timothy 2:3-4)[3]

In fact, for this reason I was born, and for this I came into the world,
to testify to the truth. Everyone on the side of truth listens to me.
(John 18:37)[4]

He chose to give us birth through the word of truth, that we
might be a kind of first-fruits of all he created.
(James 1:18)[5]

From the beginning God chose you to be saved through the
sanctifying work of the Spirit and through belief in the truth.
(2 Thessalonians 2:13)[6]

O LORD, do not your eyes look for truth?
(Jeremiah 5:3)[7]

Surely you desire truth in the inner parts; you teach me
wisdom in the inmost place.
(Psalm 51:6)[8]

He [the devil] was a murderer from the beginning,
not holding to the truth, for there is no truth in him.
(John 8:44)[9]

When he [the devil] lies, he speaks his native language,
for he is a liar and the father of lies.
(John 8:44)[10]

ourselves from the lies of the devil by living in God's truth and abiding in God's love.[11]

The Bible is the main source of truth for mankind. It contains the word of God and the teachings of his Son, Jesus Christ. Every word in the Bible is flawless,[12] perfect,[13] righteous,[14] trustworthy,[14] true[15] and eternal.[16]

As we study the word of God we gain wisdom and understanding and ultimately, we start to "walk in the truth."[17] That is, as we learn God's commandments and start following them, our thinking and actions become more and more pure.[18] We are transformed and "born again" through the living and enduring word of God that stands forever.[19] The final result of this process is that the truth literally "sets us free."[20]

May your love and your truth always protect me.
(Psalm 40:11)[11]

Every word of God is flawless.
(Proverbs 30:5)[12]

The law of the LORD is perfect, reviving the soul.
(Psalm 19:7)[13]

The statutes you have laid down are righteous;
they are fully trustworthy.
(Psalm 119:138)[14]

Sanctify them by the truth; your word is truth.
(John 17:17)[15]

All your words are true; all your righteous laws are eternal.
(Psalm 119:160)[16]

Test me, O LORD, and try me, examine my heart and my mind; for your love is ever before me, and I walk continually in your truth.
(Psalm 26:2)[17]

Now that you have purified yourselves by obeying the truth…
love one another deeply, from the heart.
(1 Peter 1:22)[18]

For you have been born again, not of perishable seed, but of imperishable, through the living and enduring word of God.
(1 Peter 1:23)[19]

226 Truth, Seeking

In order for this transformation to take place, it is first necessary to accept and believe in the central truth of the Bible—that Jesus Christ (the Son of God) came to this earth to die for our sins[21] and that if we believe in Him and repent of our sins, we will inherit eternal life.[22] Once we accept this "gospel of salvation," we receive the Holy Spirit, who lives and dwells within us.[23-25]

The Holy Spirit, also called the "Spirit of truth,"[26] is the great Counselor who was sent by God to testify about the truth of Jesus

If you hold to my teaching, you are really my disciples.
Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free.
(John 8:31-32) [20]

He appeared so that he might take away our sins.
(1 John 3:5)[21]

That if you confess with your mouth, "Jesus is Lord,"
and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead,
you will be saved.
(Romans 10:9)[22]

Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of
Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins. And you
will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.
(Acts 2:38)[23]

And you also were included in Christ when you heard the
word of truth, the gospel of your salvation. Having believed,
you were marked in him with a seal, the promised Holy Spirit.
(Ephesians 1:13)[24]

And this is how we know that he lives in us:
We know it by the Spirit he gave us.
(1 John 3:24)[25]

And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another
Counselor to be with you forever—the Spirit of truth.
(John 14:16-17)[26]

And it is the Spirit who testifies,
because the Spirit is the truth.
(1 John 5:6)[27]

Christ,[27,28] and to guide us further into the truth as we live out our lives on this earth.[29,30]

There are always consequences for rejecting the truth and following lies.[31,32] Once we receive the truth, God wants us to "hold on to it,"[33] and not be swayed by people who try to distort the truth.[34] We must stand firm in the truth,[35] and not exchange the truths of the Bible for the lies of the world.[36]

When the Counselor comes, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of truth who goes out from the Father, he will testify about me.
(John 15:26)[28]

All this I have spoken while still with you. But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, will teach you all things and will remind you of everything I have said to you.
(John 14:25-26) [29]

But when he, the Spirit of truth, comes, he will guide you into all truth.
(John 16:13)[30]

But for those who are self-seeking and who reject the truth and follow evil, there will be wrath and anger.
(Romans 2:8)[31]

They perish because they refused to love the truth and so be saved.
(2 Thessalonians 2:10)[32]

They must keep hold of the deep truths of the faith with a clear conscience.
(1 Timothy 3:9)[33]

Even from your own number men will arise and distort the truth in order to draw away disciples after them.
(Acts 20:30)[34]

Stand firm then, with the belt of truth buckled around your waist.
(Ephesians 6:14)[35]

228 Truth, Seeking

Once we know the truth of the Bible, we cannot fool God by pretending to follow the truth and then deliberately keep on sinning. If we try to do this, we are in danger of being judged by God and going to hell.[37]

In the final analysis, our journey as Christians is a journey towards truth. In a similar manner, our journey into mental health follows this same path.

Believing in the truth has a profound influence on our thought life. Once we become Christians, God expects us to bring our thinking into line with the truth (See, Lesson 29: Thinking, Healthy).

They exchanged the truth of God for a lie, and worshiped and served created things rather than the Creator—who is forever praised. Amen.
(Romans 1:25)[36]

If we deliberately keep on sinning after we have received the knowledge of the truth, no sacrifice for sins is left, but only a fearful expectation of judgment and of raging fire that will consume the enemies of God.
(Hebrews 10:26-27)[37]